

A NEW ERA

The idea that fashion should be as intelligent as other technology such as smartphones and laptops is gradually becoming reality. Fabrics specially designed to help keep the body warm or cool are now common in gym and sporting clothes, and 3D printing has been used to make accessories such as shoes and sunglasses. But other technologies are now emerging. Google and Levi's worked together on a jacket for cyclists – the wearer can swipe, tap, or hold the left cuff to change music tracks or answer their phone while riding. In the UK, Lauren Bowker launched a range of accessories that change colour when the temperature or light changes – a tote bag that is red in winter, blue in summer, and green in spring, for example. And the Diffus bag is wired with tiny solar panels, providing power to charge a mobile phone. The Emel + Aris coat has adjustable temperature settings, thanks to built-in heat panels, which the wearer can turn up or down using a switch inside the coat. Digitsole has developed M-Cube, a shoe inner sole with sensors for collecting health data about the wearer such as their body temperature, heart rate, and posture while walking – the stored information can then be used to identify any potential health problems and help fix them. Although wearable technology like this is still at the experimental stage, it might soon revolutionize what we wear and how we wear it.

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Everybody could have their body scanned and order clothes that fit perfectly.

IRIS VAN HERPEN, DESIGNER, 2013

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◀ TECHNOLOGY AND ROMANCE

For Autumn/Winter 2018, Iris van Herpen used laser cutting and a special liquid coating on silk organza to imitate the movement of birds' wings.